

TABLE 7.

Age Group	No. Schooling	Grade(1-4)	Grade(5-9)	Passed G.C.E. (O.L.)	Passed G.C.E. (I) or higher
Indices					
15 - 19	100	98.6	84.4	60.0	-
20 - 24	100	97.2	81.2	56.0	30.9
25 - 29	100	99.3	80.0	51.0	30.3
30 - 34	100	99.2	82.1	54.1	41.7
35 - 39	100	95.5	80.5	56.4	44.9
40 - 44	100	94.2	84.2	59.6	51.4
45 - 49	100	96.4	85.1	68.5	54.2

Ethnic differentials - At the 1971 Census the main ethnic groups namely the Sinhalese, Sri Lanka Tamils, Indian Tamils, the Sri Lanka Moors constituted 72.0, 11.2, 9.3 and 6.5 percent respectively of the Island's population while the next in number the Burghers accounted for only 0.4 percent. The rankings of the group in terms of fertility as measured by the child-woman ratio at the 1963 and 1971 Censuses (Table 7.14) were identical and in each of these ethnic groups fertility had declined.

Table 7.15 shows crude birth rates for ethnic groups obtained from the Registrar-General's Department for 1946, 1953, 1963 and 1971. If the intercensal periods 1953-63 and 1963-71 are considered, it will be observed that the crude birth rate has declined in respect of the Sinhalese, Sri Lanka Tamils and Indian Tamils, while for the Sri Lanka Moors a small drop has occurred during the intercensal period 1963-71 after a rise until 1963.

TABLE 7.14 : CHILD-WOMAN RATIO BY ETHNIC GROUP - SRI LANKA 1963 AND 1971.

Ethnic Group	Rank	Child-Woman Ratio		Percentage Change
		1963	1971	
Sinhalese	3	741.17	598.09	-19.30
Sri Lanka Tamil	2	773.76	609.23	-21.23
Indian Tamil	4	617.11	536.54	-12.73
Sri Lanka Moor	1	940.72	767.03	-18.46
Burgher	5	550.05	427.91	-22.21

TABLE 7.15 : CRUDE BIRTH RATES BY ETHNIC GROUPS - SRI LANKA 1946 - 1971.

Year	Sinhalese	Ceylon Tamils	Indian Tamils	Ceylon Moors	Burghers & Eurasians
1946	38.7	35.6	41.2	41.7	35.3
1953	41.0	39.2	33.0	42.7	31.1
1963	34.5	37.6	28.3	42.9	26.9
1971	29.9	31.8	25.7	39.0	18.3